AppearAI

ACCOUNT EXECUTIVE ONBOARDING · NOVEMBER 2026

Welcome, Stefan.

Your field guide to AppearAI: what we sell, who buys it, every motion that feeds the pipeline, and the tools you will run it on.

Prepared by Grischa Bauguitte, Marketing and GTM

Internal. Do not forward.

ABOUT

We help businesses get discovered in AI search.

About

AppearAI helps brands get discovered in AI search by making their content easier for AI to find, understand, and recommend.

Mission

We help businesses get discovered in AI search by making their content easier for AI to find, understand, and recommend.

Vision

A future where every business has the opportunity to be seen and trusted in the age of AI.

Our creative direction is called Nature Bathing. Buyers come to us anxious about being overlooked by AI. We sell calm and clarity, not fear. Keep that tone on every call.

Source: AppearAI Brand Guidelines, Nov 2026

WHY NOW

Buyers now ask AI who to hire. The AI names a handful of businesses.

When someone asks ChatGPT for the best HVAC company in Dallas, they get one answer naming a few companies, not ten blue links. If a business is not in that answer, it does not exist to that buyer.

73%

of B2B buyers already use AI tools in their research.

B2B SaaS Citation Benchmarks Report, 2026

60%

of searches end without a click, because the answer is given directly.

Bain and Company, 2025

80%

of URLs cited by AI sit outside Google's top 100. Ranking on Google is a different game.

Ahrefs, 2025

14.2%

conversion from AI search versus 2.8% from Google. Buyers arrive pre sold.

Superprompt, 12M visit study

Use only these stats, written exactly like this. Never "AI is replacing Google". The honest framing: AI is a new channel that converts better.

Source: verified stats list, Marketing

HOW IT WORKS

Two audiences, one website. We call it adaptive rendering.

Websites are built for people: images, scripts, menus. AI crawlers read raw text, so most of what makes a business worth recommending is invisible to them. AppearAI runs a delivery layer alongside the site, on its own hostname. People see the site exactly as before. AI crawlers get a version built for machines: clear structure, direct answers to real buyer questions, services and locations stated plainly.

SETUP IS ONE DNS RECORD. TYPICAL EXAMPLE:

Type	CNAME
Name	appear
Value	proxy.joinappear.com
Result	appear.yourdomain.com

The account manager confirms the exact record per site. On Cloudflare the proxy must be set to DNS only.

What we do continuously

+ **Buyer questions:** find what real buyers ask AI in the category, and answer them
+ **Coverage:** track citations across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Claude
+ **Competitors:** show who gets named instead, and how they compare
+ **Content:** build answers to questions the site does not cover yet

What AppearAI is not

Not SEO. SEO ranks a page in a list. We get a business named inside a generated answer. **Not a monitoring tool.** Trackers report. We change what AI can read. **Not instant.** Answer engines recrawl on their own schedule.

Source: Help Center, "What does Appear actually do?" and "How do I connect my website?"

AFTER THE SIGNATURE

What the customer gets, and what you will demo.

ONBOARDING STAGES

Welcome email	Link to book the onboarding call
DNS record added	Nothing finishes until this is done
We read the site	Builds the business Profile
Proposals	Buyer questions to track and pages to create
Approval	New pages are approved before they go live
Measurement	First numbers are the starting line, not a verdict

Sell this truthfully: there is no fixed date for results. Narrow, local questions usually move first.

DASHBOARD SCREENS

Home	Live status, AI traffic, live pages, mentioned or cited in X of Y queries
Pages	Agent Pages and Proposals, with comments
Knowledge base	The Profile and approved business facts
Traffic	Requests by AI agent, class, purpose and outcome
Queries	Buyer questions, latest result per engine, weekly change
Competitors	Discovery score, position and answers, per engine and week
Backlinks	Placements our team has recorded

Source: Help Center, "What happens after I sign up?" and "What am I looking at in my dashboard?"

PLANS AND PRICING

Priced per domain, per month. Three month minimum, then monthly.

STANDARD

$2,500

per domain per month

GEO audit and technical setup, schema and entities, an AI readable version of every page, monthly refresh, monthly reports and competitor tracking.

Plan target: results in 60 to 90 days

GROWTH

$3,500

per domain per month

Everything in Standard, plus bi weekly refresh, topic architecture, new content, citation building and advanced competitor intelligence.

Plan target: results in 45 to 60 days

ENTERPRISE

$5,000

per domain per month

Everything in Growth, plus weekly refresh, a dedicated account manager, priority support and a custom reporting dashboard.

Plan target: results in 30 to 45 days

Negotiate on value, not discounts. If a buyer wants a lower price, ask which capability or outcome they would give up.

No price in cold email. Price is a call conversation. The proposal goes out only after the champion confirms we solve the problem.

Self serve is not live yet. Lower priced entry plans are still being defined. Never promise them.

Source: AE Role and Context, Battle Cards (Oct 2026). Plan targets are targets, never guarantees.

EVERYTHING WE DO

One engine, sold two ways, fed by free proof.

THE PLATFORM

AppearAI

Software plus a managed service, sold per domain on Standard, Growth and Enterprise. AE owned, deals in GHL, contracts in PandaDoc. **This is what you sell.**

+ Agent Website and adaptive rendering
+ Content created for buyer questions
+ Measurement by engine and competitor

THE AGENCY

The Rank Collective

Our own AEO and GEO agency brand for owner led SMBs who want it done for them. Own domain, inboxes, calendar and TRC Pipeline in GHL. Calls go to Rocky and Jordon in rotation.

Hard rule: never mix the brands on a lead. No TRC inbox on an AppearAI lead, no AppearAI signature on a TRC lead. If a lead sits in the wrong place, flag it in Slack.

THE PROOF

Free audits and scans

Prospects request a free AI visibility audit, which lands in Slack and on the contact in GHL. The website also offers a free scan. Every audit names five to ten local competitors, which becomes our best outbound list.

`The site states the scan is not proof of rankings, recommendations or revenue. Say the same.`

Source: Our Products, Sales Playbook, Lead Sourcing Engine Playbook, joinappear.com

WHO BUYS

High ticket, location based businesses whose website drives leads.

Active verticals

PI law | DSOs | Med spas | RIAs | HVAC | Fertility | Franchise networks | Private schools

Strongest in healthcare, legal, home and professional services, and insurance. Multi location groups get the most value, because each location gets its own details.

Segment is size, not vertical

SMB: 1 to 500 employees, up to $2.5K MRR.
Enterprise: 500+ employees, above $2.5K MRR.

Who is a decision maker

Single location	Owner, President, GM, CEO
Multi location	CEO, President, Founder, COO, VP or Head of Marketing
Not a buyer	Office manager, dispatcher, marketing coordinator. Go above them.

Whoever owns the website and DNS must be in the scoping call, or the deal stalls at setup.

Signals worth acting on

+ No schema markup
+ Content rendered client side with JavaScript
+ robots.txt blocking AI crawlers
+ Several locations or domains (we price per domain)
+ Competitors named by ChatGPT more often than them

Agencies are not for AEs. Marketing and SEO agencies go to the partner program, not to you.

Source: AE Role and Context, lemlist playbook, Lead Sourcing Engine Playbook

COMPETITION

Trackers report the gap. AppearAI closes it.

IF THEY USE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT YOU SAY
Profound, Peec, Otterly	AI visibility tracking	Good, use it as our scorecard. We include competitor tracking anyway.
Semrush AI Toolkit	$99 a month per domain, prompts and audit	It shows the score. AppearAI changes it.
Ahrefs Brand Radar	AI mention tracking inside Ahrefs	Keep it for SEO. Nothing changes for AI crawlers.
HubSpot AEO Grader	Free AI visibility grade	A good free snapshot. It shows the problem, we fix it.
Frase, Surfer, Writesonic	Content tools adding tracking	They help your team write. We serve what AI needs without the writing.
Yext Scout	Listings for multi location brands	Yext manages listings. We control what AI reads on your own domain, one entity per location.

The one line

Every other tool shows you the problem. AppearAI changes what AI crawlers receive, hosts it on your domain, and measures what moves.

Before any competitive call

Open the Battle Cards in the Sales Space. They have one page per competitor (Profound, Peec, Scrunch, Prerender, Cloudflare, Otterly, AthenaHQ and more), checked against vendor sites on 14 October 2026.

Source: Battle Cards, Oct 2026

OBJECTIONS

The ones you will hear in week one.

IS THIS CLOAKING?

Cloaking means showing Google something different to game Google. Googlebot gets the normal site. AI crawlers get a structured version of the same approved facts. Answer it head on.

WE ALREADY DO SEO

Keep doing it. SEO is for Google. AI engines read and choose businesses differently. The two work together. Never bash their agency.

TOOLS COST $99. WHY $2,500?

Tools report, we fix and host. Rebuild the maths with their own cost per lead and customer value from discovery.

CAN YOU GUARANTEE RESULTS?

No one controls what AI says. We control what AI crawlers receive and we measure it. Plans carry result targets, not promises.

YOU ARE SMALL

True, we are young. Trying is low risk: one DNS record, nothing changes on the site, remove it to undo. Never claim a certification we do not hold.

SEND ME SOME INFO

Do not send a deck. Send one specific, checkable observation: what ChatGPT says when asked for the best in their city. Or offer two call times.

If a customer cancels: remove the record and routing returns to normal. What AI already learned may stay, but no new improvements reach new crawls.

Source: Battle Cards, SMB Playbook, outbound objection guide

PROOF

Published results. Quote them exactly as written.

SAAS · RETELL AI

36 of 40

buyer questions tested across four AI engines named or cited Retell.

BANKING · 200 LOCAL BANKS

11% → 58%

named answers in 12 weeks after publishing public condition pages.

HOME SERVICES · DERBY STRONG

18% → 34%

same question mention, April to August. AI crawler hits up 2.4x.

HEALTHCARE · THE SEE CLINIC

67%

of August Perplexity answers named the clinic. AI crawler hits up 2.7x.

FITNESS · FETTLE

69%

of August ChatGPT answers named Fettle, and 49% cited it.

HVAC · COPELAND, TEXAS

Missing → named

April 2026 absent from the answer. September 2026 named and cited, through its emergency AC repair page.

These show visibility, not revenue. Never present them as lead or revenue guarantees. Home services proof for outbound: Copeland, Rock Service Pros, CR3 and Burkentine.

Source: joinappear.com case studies, read 9 Nov 2026

THE MOTIONS

Know where a lead came from before you open your mouth.

MOTION	HOW IT WORKS	WHERE IT LANDS	YOUR PART
AE outbound `lemlist, calls, your book`	Multichannel sequences (email, LinkedIn, calls) on accounts you own. Smaller, higher value lists and fresh buying signals.	GHL, as a deal once the meeting is booked	**Your core motion.** Built on the next pages.
Central cold email `Instantly, AppearAI`	”We asked ChatGPT for the best [niche] in [city]. It named three competitors, not you.” Reply ”show me”.	Echo, our reply agent, answers in auto send mode and books the Appear Intro calendar	Run the booked call. Take over the thread once it is yours.
TRC outbound `Instantly, The Rank Collective`	About 10,000 emails a month from 30 TRC inboxes to US owners: financial advisors, med spas, real estate, luxury travel. Goal: 30 to 50 calls a month.	TRC Intro calendar, round robin	Know the brand line. Never cross inboxes.
Inbound `Meta lead ads, audits, forms`	New leads and audit requests post to Slack with site and CRM link. Bookings trigger reminders by text and email.	Company owner, or the territory AE	Demo requests within 5 minutes in business hours.
Partners `Agencies and resellers`	Agencies refer or resell under the partner program.	Partner program. Partner accounts protected for 60 days.	Route agencies to Grischa. Check before you prospect.
Self serve `Not live yet`	Product qualified leads: a fit account plus one hand raise, or two usage signals within 14 days.	Company owner, once PQL date is set	Work PQLs the same business day.

Source: lemlist playbook, Slack GTM channels (Nov 2026), SLA and handoff rules

YOUR OUTBOUND SYSTEM

Territory first, then list, then campaign. The goal is always a booked video call.

PLAN

Territory plan

One vertical and one persona per campaign. V1 in onboarding, V2 after review with Grischa.

→

SOURCE

Build the list

lemlist People Database, Sales Navigator, central lists, GHL, treg.

→

CHECK

Clean it

Verified email, LinkedIn URL. No customers, open deals, other owners or unsubscribes.

→

SEND

Sequence

Email, LinkedIn and call steps. First batch 50 to 100 leads.

→

BOOK

Call

Cold calls book a meeting, never pitch. 30MPC "Cold Calling Sucks" framework.

Your weekly capacity

Your LinkedIn account sets it, not your mailboxes. At 20 invites a day, one account reaches about **100 new prospects a week**. Build Monday's list around that number.

Your book

One owner per domain, set in GHL. Check the owner before you reach out. Up to 15 open pool claims a month, logged with a meaningful activity the same day.

Keep it alive

No meaningful activity in 45 days flags the account. At 60 days it returns to the pool. A sequence enrolment alone is not meaningful activity.

Source: lemlist playbook, AE Role and Context. Book rules marked proposed may still change.

THE HOOK THAT WORKS

Do not tell them they are invisible. Show them who AI recommends instead.

FIRST LINE, FROM THE SOURCING PLAYBOOK

”We checked who ChatGPT recommends for HVAC in Dallas. 3 competitors come up more often than you.”

The first line is news, not a pitch. It is specific, checkable in ten seconds, and it names rivals. That is the critical event AI visibility otherwise lacks.

Rules for every claim

+ Rank based claims only: ”comes up less often than”. Never ”you are invisible”.
+ Save every ChatGPT answer with its date. Answers change between runs.
+ Never mention the business whose audit surfaced the lead.
+ Talk about patients, clients and bookings, not crawlers and schema.
+ Branch on replies and acceptances, never on opens. Keep open tracking off.

Source: Lead Sourcing Engine Playbook, lemlist playbook

THE HONEST MATHS

Reply rate and reply handling move meetings, not more leads.

CENTRAL COLD EMAIL, 21 SEP TO 21 OCT 2026, PER 1,000 CONTACTS

STEP	TODAY	PLAN	STRONG
Reply rate	2.07%	3%	4%
Positive share of replies	12.2%	20%	25%
Positive reply to booked	60%	60%	70%
Show rate	75%	75%	80%
Qualified rate	50%	60%	60%
Qualified meetings	**0.6**	**1.6**	**3.4**

Today's reply and positive rates are measured (90 replies from 4.4K contacts, 11 positive). The later steps are working assumptions.

A qualified meeting needs all four

+ The right company
+ A decision maker on the call
+ They showed up
+ They admitted a problem out loud

What this means for lemlist

Track positive reply rate and meetings per 100 leads. Keep bounces under 2%. At 200 leads with no positive reply, change the list or the angle. A new subject line will not fix it.

Source: Lead Sourcing Engine Playbook (Instantly data), lemlist playbook

THE STACK

Each tool has one job. GHL is the truth.

TOOL	WHAT IT IS FOR	YOUR RULE
lemlist	Your multichannel outbound: email, LinkedIn and calls in one sequence, with Signals.	Send only from your assigned mailboxes. Never connect your main inbox.
Instantly	High volume, email only campaigns for AppearAI and TRC, managed centrally.	Check GHL for recent Instantly contact before adding anyone to lemlist.
treg	One key for many data tools: people search, Google Maps, live ChatGPT answers.	Check with Grischa before any large run. There is a daily limit.
GoHighLevel	Our CRM and system of record: contacts, owners, deals and pipelines, plus Meta leads, audit requests, booking calendars and reminders.	If a meeting, next step or deal change is not in GHL, it did not happen. Read the audit on the contact before every call.
PandaDoc	Proposals and contracts.	Proposal only after the champion confirms fit.
Sales Navigator	Research and list building, with the lemlist Chrome extension.	Imports keep the LinkedIn URL. Name the CSV column linkedinUrl.
Slack and Notion	Lead alerts, deal help and the Sales Space with every playbook.	Share what worked every Friday in the sales channel.

Source: Sales Space, lemlist playbook, SLA and handoff rules

LEMLIST

Where your pipeline gets built.

Already set up, leave it

+ lemwarm stays on for every mailbox
+ Under 40 emails a day from a mailbox under a year old
+ LinkedIn: 20 invites, 30 visits, 30 messages a day, manual activity included
+ Log every booked meeting and deal in GHL

Something looks wrong? Pause the campaign and message Grischa.

Building a campaign

+ One vertical, persona, trigger and call to action
+ Name it Owner | Vertical | Persona | Trigger | YYMM
+ Route "Deliverable" emails down the email path, the rest to LinkedIn only
+ Gate LinkedIn steps on "Has LinkedIn URL", messages on "Accepted invite"
+ Exit on reply, any channel. Prospect time zone, Monday to Friday

Working replies

Interested	Book the call, mark interested, deal in GHL
Not now	Ask when, set a task
Wrong person	Ask who, add them with the referral
Stop	Unsubscribe list, every tool, forever

Check the inbox twice a day. Positive replies the same day, ideally within two hours.

Signals are your warmest leads: job changes of former champions, target accounts hiring marketing roles, posts mentioning ChatGPT or AI search, engagers on our founders' posts, and custom checks like "opened a new location in the last 30 days".

Source: lemlist playbook, Sales Space (Oct 2026)

INSTANTLY AND GHL

The central engines that hand you meetings.

INSTANTLY

High volume email, run centrally

+ Hosts the AppearAI ChatGPT competitor campaigns and the TRC engine
+ Leads are found, checked and loaded nightly. Every lead is graded before money is spent on it
+ Echo drafts and sends replies, and posts a log card for every email in the outbound agent channel
+ When a contact replies or books, take over: stop the sequence, log the reply and the meeting in GHL
+ Sending stops automatically if bounces pass 3%

GOHIGHLEVEL

Inbound, bookings and the TRC pipeline

+ New Meta lead and New call booked alerts post to Slack with the Meet link
+ Each contact holds the AI audit status, notes and full report link
+ Reminders go out 24 hours and 1 hour before. Leads reply C to confirm or R to reschedule
+ Before every call: open the audit, note two or three places competitors show up and the lead does not
+ Move TRC deals the same day something happens

Source: Sales Playbook (GHL), Slack outbound updates, SLA and handoff rules

TREG

One key for many data tools. Use it with intent.

treg sits between us and the data providers. Instead of a separate account for every provider, you call the tool you need through one key. We use it for people search, Google Maps data, and live answers from ChatGPT for a given city and question.

JOB	HOW WE HAVE USED IT
Find decision makers	People search by title, company, size and location. Run a count first
Find competitors in AI	Ask ChatGPT "best [business] in [city]" per city, check who is named
Local businesses	Google Maps for website and reviews

How to work with it

+ Check with Grischa before any large run
+ There is a daily limit. Ask Grischa if you hit it
+ On a timeout, retry with the same idempotency key
+ Run at most two calls at a time

Where not to use it

Email finding. We keep our own enrichment waterfall and MillionVerifier, because bad data burns sending domains. Central lists are already verified, so never enrich them again.

Source: Lead Sourcing Engine Playbook, internal treg campaign brief (Oct 2026)

SPEED AND PROCESS

Fast to respond, strict on exit criteria.

FIRST RESPONSE TARGETS, BUSINESS HOURS 9:00 TO 18:00 YOUR TIME

Demo request or hot inbound	5 minutes
Enterprise inbound	4 business hours
PQL	same business day
Other inbound form	1 business day
Positive outbound reply, SMB	1 business day
Positive outbound reply, Enterprise	4 business hours

A response is a personal call, email or LinkedIn message logged in GHL. Inbound leads get at least five touches over ten business days before Bad Timing or Unqualified.

How we sell

Command of the Message in every conversation. **BANT** as a light pass when the meeting is booked, **MEDDPICC** from Discovery on. Create the deal once the first meeting is booked. A deal moves only when the buyer confirms the exit criteria.

On the call

Frame, discover their channels and customer value, pitch in their words, show the human view next to the AI view, then offer the next step and stop talking. Talk 45 to 55 percent of the time.

At Closed Won

Within one business day: update the deal in GHL with plan, MRR, domains and start date, and note who controls DNS. Until AMs are hired, you keep the account through the three month minimum.

Source: SLA and handoff rules (Oct 2026), AE Role and Context, SMB Playbook

YOUR TARGETS

A closing target you can earn into, built on meetings you create.

CLOSING TARGET, NEW MRR (FROM YOUR YEAR ONE PLAN)

QUARTER	NEW MRR	RUNNING TOTAL
Q4 (Nov 9 to Dec)	$7.2k	$7.2k
Q1 2027	$22k	$29.2k
Q2 2027	$22.5k	$51.7k
Q3 2027	$23.3k	$75k

$75k new MRR by Sep 30, 2027 ($900k ARR). Stretch bonus above $90k. No cap. Your signed Compensation Letter governs the figures.

SELF SOURCED QUALIFIED MEETINGS HELD, EXPECTATION

Nov 9 to Dec 8	6	Lists, warmup, first sequences
Dec 9 to Jan 8	10	Holidays slow everyone
Jan 9 to Feb 8	15	Sequences mature
From Feb 9	**20 / month**	About five a week

At full ramp the target is about three deals a month. At a 15% meeting to close rate that is 20 held meetings. Quality matters as much as volume: in May the rate was 6%.

Source: Year One Plan and Schedule A, AE Role and Context pipeline maths

RHYTHM AND PEOPLE

Two meetings a week. The rest is yours to run.

Monday	Team meeting. Pipeline, the week ahead, and the list you are building.
Friday	Team meeting. Campaign numbers, meetings booked, what worked and what to change.

Hands off by design. No daily standups, no forecast calls. You own your calendar, your book and your numbers. Keep GHL current so nobody has to ask, and shout in Slack the moment you need help.

Alana

Paid ads and lead ops. Meta campaigns, lead assignment in GHL.

Grischa Bauguitte

Marketing and GTM. Your go to for campaigns, claims, tools and partners.

Alykhan Kara

CEO, product and platform. Product training, Stripe, PandaDoc.

Rocky and Jordon

AEs. Shadow five of their discovery and demo calls in week one.

Arafen

Lead sourcing engine, grading and inbox health.

Echo

Our reply agent. Posts every reply it sends to Slack.

Source: Grischa, Nov 2026

AppearAI

A future where every business has the opportunity to be seen and trusted in the age of AI.

Welcome aboard, Stefan.

Internal. Do not forward.